THREAT BRIEFING · 27 OCTOBER 2026

Japan’s October 2026 Cyber Emergency

Attack types, what happened, how to remediate, and how to prevent the next one

THE SCALE

A record year, then a national emergency

500+

cyber incidents in Japan in 2026, a new annual record

495

companies and local governments hit by one cloud ransomware attack

123

ransomware cases reported to police in the first half of 2026, a record

Oct 9

government declares a “state of emergency in cyberspace”

Japan’s Active Cyber Defense Law took effect on 1 October: mandatory incident reporting for 257 critical infrastructure operators and new powers to neutralize attacker infrastructure.

Sources: UV Cyber threat advisory; CS2 / National Police Agency; The Next Web

WHAT HAPPENED

Five weeks of disclosures

Date	Event
25 Sep	Times Car: about 6.6 million records; Tokyo Metro’s outsourced mail server accessed
2 Oct	Osaka Metropolitan University ransomware: about 500 servers stop
5 Oct	Yakiniku King (10.8M records); Daiwa Securities hit through vendor Scala Communications
7 Oct	IDC Frontier cloud ransomware: 495 companies and local governments affected
9 Oct	Government declares a state of emergency in cyberspace
17 Oct	First attempts to exploit the PHP2Shell flaws, before any patch exists
21 Oct	PHP patch released; Japanese banks and agencies pause sites; Saitama Police data of 13,000 staff at risk
26–27 Oct	GMO Internet Group FX breach; $50M ransom refused

Sources: CS2 breach-wave analysis; SOCRadar; News On Japan; Bloomberg

ATTACK TYPES

Six ways the attacks unfolded

Ransomware

Encrypts servers and backups, then demands payment

Data theft and extortion

Customer records stolen, with threats to leak them

Supply chain

A vendor or cloud breach reaches all of its clients

Vulnerability exploits

Unpatched software, such as the PHP2Shell flaws

Accounts and settings

Hijacked accounts and CMS or API misconfiguration

AI-accelerated

An AI pen-testing tool, ARTEX, linked to attacks on ~20 firms

Sources: CS2; Malware News / SOCRadar; GMO Cybersecurity by IERAE (19 Oct)

KEY INCIDENTS · RANSOMWARE

One shared layer, hundreds of victims

IDC Frontier (SoftBank cloud)

- 7 Oct, about 03:40: ransomware hits IDCF Cloud East Japan Region 1
- 495 companies and local governments affected
- JR East and Views Card: up to ~6M member records possibly exposed
- Customers told to restore from their own backups

Osaka Metropolitan University

- 2 Oct: outage across all five campuses
- Attacker reached the shared virtualization platform
- About 500 servers stopped
- Most backups were encrypted too

Lesson: backups and recovery that live on the same layer fail together.

Sources: CS2 breach-wave analysis (citing TECH+, NHK, IDC Frontier reports); UV Cyber

KEY INCIDENTS · DATA BREACHES

How the attackers got in

Entry point	Disclosed examples
A vendor’s server	Scala Communications: Daiwa Securities (~110k), Citizen Watch (~100k); Tokyo Metro’s mail vendor (~59k)
API or CMS setting	Shueisha: config error; attacker created a high-privilege account via the API
Software vulnerability	GMO Research & AI (up to 948k records); Mr Max (up to 1.7M members)
One compromised account	Nikkei: a Microsoft 365 account sent about 9,000 phishing emails
Virtualization or cloud	Osaka Metropolitan University; IDC Frontier and its customers

In 5 of 7 cases with a known discovery route, an outsider noticed first.

Source: CS2, “Japan’s October 2026 breach wave” (14 Oct 2026). Counts are maximums possibly affected.

KEY INCIDENTS · VULNERABILITY

PHP2Shell: exploited before the patch

CVE-2026-109618
CVE-2026-109619

Memory-safety flaws in PHP 5.4–8.5 that allow **remote code execution without authentication**

Japanese banks, restaurant chains and government sites paused online services as a precaution

17 Oct	First exploitation attempts observed
21 Oct	Fixes: PHP 8.5.12, 8.4.27, 8.3.36, 8.2.35
22 Oct	JPCERT/CC and IPA issue alerts; patch and check for compromise
23 Oct	Separate flaw CVE-2026-115560 disclosed, not fixed by the 21 Oct releases

Sources: JPCERT-AT-2026-0033; IPA alert 20261022; SOCRadar; Anadolu Agency; News On Japan

KEY INCIDENTS · EXTORTION

GMO Internet Group: the latest target

$50M

ransom demanded (about ¥7.9B) — refused by GMO

Early reports cited $1M; GMO’s president disclosed $50M

Entry: Onamae.com Desktop Cloud service; up to 26,739 servers potentially exposed

Impact: five FX margin-trading services breached, unauthorized trades; accounts at 70+ securities and FX firms reached

Threat: attackers claimed to publish customer data after the deadline

Response: customers told to scan PCs, back up files, unplug and power off; losses reimbursed plus ¥5,000 per client

Sources: Bloomberg (26 Oct); News On Japan; BigGo Finance; CoinCentral; TokyoReporter

REMEDIATION

If you are affected: six steps now

01

Contain

Isolate affected systems; follow vendor instructions to disconnect

02

Patch

Upgrade PHP now; for CVE-2026-115560, turn off session upload progress until fixed

03

Hunt

Check logs back to 17 Oct for signs of compromise, not just patch

04

Reset

Rotate exposed credentials and enforce multi-factor authentication

05

Restore

Recover from your own isolated backups; preserve logs for forensics

06

Report

Notify police and the Personal Information Protection Commission

Sources: JPCERT-AT-2026-0033; IPA alert 20261022; IDC Frontier guidance via CS2; GMO customer notice

PREVENTION

Close the doors these attacks used

Control	Why it matters
Patch VPNs and add MFA	VPN devices were the most common first entry point for ransomware
Keep an isolated backup; test it	Osaka and IDC Frontier lost backups on the same layer
Inventory your vendors	Know who holds customer data; confirm deletion when contracts end
Alert on new admin accounts	Shueisha’s attacker created a high-privilege account via API
Review sign-ins daily	Outsiders spotted most breaches before the victims did
Patch fast; watch JVN alerts	PHP2Shell was exploited before a fix existed
Write a response contact list	IT, cloud, forensics, police and PPC — decided in advance

Sources: CS2 checklist (citing National Police Agency data); JPCERT/CC; JVN

TAKEAWAY

None of these entry points were new. AI is changing the speed, not the method.

The basics — patching, MFA, isolated backups, vendor control and daily monitoring — still stop most of this wave.

Official advisories and analysis

Official advisories

JPCERT/CC alert JPCERT-AT-2026-0033 (PHP vulnerabilities)
https://www.jpcert.or.jp/at/2026/at260033.html

IPA security alert on PHP2Shell (22 Oct 2026)
https://www.ipa.go.jp/security/security-alert/2026/alert20261022.html

Japan Vulnerability Notes (JVNVU#99905564)
https://jvn.jp/

Analysis

CS2: Japan’s October 2026 breach wave
https://www.cybers2.com/blog/japan-breach-wave-october-2026.html

UV Cyber: Japan’s cyber emergency and its ripple effects
https://www.uvcyber.com/resources/threat-advisories/threat-advisory-japans-cyber-emergency-and-its-ripple-effects

Malware News / SOCRadar: Inside the October surge
https://malware.news/t/japan-data-breaches-2026-inside-the-october-surge/126558

SOCRadar: PHP2Shell explained
https://socradar.io/blog/php2shell-cve-2026-109618-cve-2026-109619/

News: the GMO Internet Group attack

Bloomberg: Trading platform rocked by Japan hack, $50 million ransom (26 Oct)
https://www.bloomberg.com/news/articles/2026-10-26/japan-s-katayama-vows-to-address-cyber-attack-on-fx-with-urgency

News On Japan: GMO refuses to pay $50 million cyberattack ransom
https://newsonjapan.com/article/151147.php

BigGo Finance: GMO refuses $50 million ransom, will repay FX losses
https://finance.biggo.com/news/b79624a0-b5ec-4c7d-bc8b-9dcb4f00ed22

CoinCentral: GMO warns users to unplug computers
https://coincentral.com/gmo-internet-group-warns-users-to-unplug-computers-as-hackers-threaten-ransomware-attack

TokyoReporter: GMO refuses ransom demand after cyberattack
https://www.tokyoreporter.com/japan-news/tech-giant-gmo-refuses-1m-ransom-demand-from-hacker-syndicate-after-massive-cyberattack/

News: the wider wave and PHP2Shell

News On Japan: Cyberattacks hit Japanese police and businesses
https://newsonjapan.com/article/151111.php

The Next Web: Japan steps up cyber warnings as data leaks hit millions
https://thenextweb.com/news/japan-cyberattacks-warning-data-leaks

Anadolu Agency: Japan suspends websites over critical PHP vulnerabilities
https://www.aa.com.tr/en/asia-pacific/japan-suspends-several-websites-over-critical-php-security-vulnerabilities/4096314

Tech Times: Japan declares first cyberspace emergency
https://www.techtimes.com/articles/328908/20261012/japan-declares-first-cyberspace-emergency-ai-turns-ransomware-carpet-bombing.htm

Figures as reported up to 27 Oct 2026; many are maximums possibly affected, not confirmed leaks.